CURRICULUM BOOK

Cash to Company

GRADE 5

Curriculum Book

Money, pricing, and profit

Cost, price, profit. Real numbers. Real customers.

ABOUT THIS BOOK

Grade 5 - Curriculum Book

Cost, price, profit. Real numbers. Real customers. This book is part of the Cash to Company K-12 program - a financial literacy and entrepreneurship curriculum aligned to Jump$tart, CEE, CCSS, C3, and CASEL standards.

A short, practical guide for the adult who lives with a Grade 5 Cash to Company student.

Money in, money out, money left

Cost, price, profit - in real numbers.

What this year is

"*Revenue is loud. What's left is what you keep.*"

- CASH, GRADE 5

This year, your student is learning to think about money the way a small-business owner does. The big move is **profit is what is left** — the difference between money in and money out.

Across the year, your student picks one Capstone idea — a pretend or real small business — and sharpens it through four moves: choosing it, pricing it, defending it against persuasion tactics, and running it at a Classroom Market Day. By June, they will deliver a written debrief covering what worked, what flopped, and what they would change.

Most students do not start a real business this year. The point is the thinking: figuring out unit cost, picking a price, spotting tricks in advertising, and writing down honestly what happened.

What your student is bringing home

> **TRY THIS**
>
> ### Cost it out
>
> Make the thing you want to sell. Write down every supply you used and what each one cost. Add it up. That's your cost per one.

You will see:

- A **Capstone Journal** — the messy notebook where they sketch and reflect.
- A **Student Activity Book** — structured worksheets with idea webs, pricing math, ad analysis, and reflection prompts.
- Occasional **Cash videos** to watch (2–3 minutes each) — short animated explainers from the program's mascot, Cash. Cash is curious and warm. Cash never tells students they are "amazing" or that they will be rich. Cash asks questions.
- An **idea web** — your student will probably ask you about something you are good at, a hobby of yours, or a need you see in your day.

They will likely talk about their "customer," "cost," "revenue," "profit," and "margin." They will start spotting tricks in ads — *scarcity, social proof, urgency, fear*. Your student will explain.

What you don't need to do

WORDS TO KNOW

Cost
Money out - what it takes to make or deliver one unit.

Price
Money in - what the customer pays for one unit.

Profit
Price minus cost. What is left after costs are paid.

Margin
Profit shown as a percentage of price.

Revenue
Total money in across many sales - loud, but not the same as profit.

- **You don't need to know any of this.** A parent with no business background can fully support this curriculum.
- **You don't need to fund anything.** Capstones are educational. The Market Day uses classroom-currency tokens or low-cost supplies.
- **You don't need to share your finances.** No student is asked to share family financial details. If a homework prompt seems to ask, contact the teacher — it should not.

What you can do (if you want)

MATH MOMENT

Profit per unit

Cost per one: $1.40. Price per one: $4.00. Profit per one is price minus cost. What's left? If you sell 12, what's the total profit?

These are optional. None are required.

One good question per quarter

- **September–October (Unit 1):** "*What is one business idea you have been thinking about? Who is the customer — really?*"
- **November–January (Unit 2):** "*If a lemonade cup costs you 30 cents to make, and you charge a dollar, what's left?*"
- **February–April (Unit 3):** "*Show me an ad you have seen recently. What is it trying to make you feel?*"
- **May–June (Unit 4):** "*What worked at your Market Day? What flopped? What would you change next time?*"

You do not need to know the right answer. You are modeling curiosity, not expertise.

Notice ads with them

When you see an ad that feels manipulative — fake countdown, "doctors hate this trick," vague "everyone is buying" — ask your student what they think. They have been trained on five techniques. Hearing them apply the names is a window into how they think.

Share a small-business story

If you have ever started something small — a side service, a club, a fundraiser, a household project — your story is gold. The most useful thing you can share is what you got wrong and what you did about it.

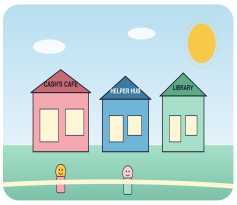
Be a customer (only if asked)

Your student may want to interview you about a small problem you have. If you are comfortable, give honest answers — including the boring parts. The most useful thing you can do is *not be a cheerleader.* If interviewing you does not feel right, it is fine to say so.

Things to watch for

CASH ASKS

"*What did they actually say? Tell me one real sentence.*"



PEOPLE YOU CAN ASK

Five real prices

Ask: 'Would you pay $5 for this? $4? $3?' Write what they say. The number people actually pay is the only one that counts.

A "great idea" that needs you to spend money

Two responses both work:

- **"What did your math say it would cost? What is the price? What is left?"** (Pulls them into the work.)
- **"This sounds like a real-life version, not a class version. We can talk about whether to do that."**

The Capstone can be done entirely with paper, markers, and template supplies.

A pitch that is all hype

If your student says "everybody is going to love this," gently ask: "*Which everybody? How would you know?*" That is the year's spine question.

Something that does not sit right

If your student's pitch leans toward exclusion, body-image messaging, or a manipulative tactic ("this drink will make you popular"), mention it to the teacher. The curriculum has built-in pivot windows in Weeks 9 and 19 for exactly this.

Privacy and sensitivity

FAMILY TALK

Loud vs. left

Ask: 'What's the difference between revenue and profit?' Then explain it back in your own words, with one example from your idea.

The curriculum:

- Uses **fictional customers**, not classmates' real names.
- Avoids **family financial details** entirely.
- Uses **classroom-currency tokens** at the Market Day instead of real money, by default.
- Frames the Market Day as a *classroom market* (craft fair, service auction) — not a meal — to avoid surfacing food-insecurity concerns.

If something feels off, contact the teacher.

A note about success this year

CASH ASKS

"*Five ideas beats one idea. Pick the most real-sounding one.*"

A successful Grade 5 student:

- Picked a customer specific enough to defend.
- Computed cost, revenue, and profit at three sales volumes.
- Set a price and explained why.
- Identified at least three persuasion techniques in real ads.
- Wrote a Market Day debrief with two specific changes they would make.

If you see those five things on the kitchen table over the year, the program worked.

What Cash sounds like

Cash is the program's animated mascot — a friendly, coin-shaped character. Cash is never hyped. Cash never says "amazing!" or "easy money." Cash says:

- "*You picked this idea. How do you know somebody actually wants it?*"
- "*Total sales is loud. Profit is true.*"
- "*That's a choice. What do you think will happen at that price?*"

If your student parrots one of these phrases at home, you have heard Cash. The program is built so that students think clearly about money — not so they make money. That distinction matters.

Questions?

CASH SAYS

"*First tries get something wrong. The fix is what makes you a real entrepreneur.*"

Your student's teacher is the first stop. They can send home longer materials if you would like a deeper look. Thank you for being part of this. The biggest predictor of whether financial-thinking habits stick is whether they are also alive at home — even at one curious question a quarter.

— The Cash to Company team

Senior expert upgrade pack — Four ad-spotting prompts (Grade 5)

Prompt 1 — The TV ad

You: "*What did that ad just want you to feel?*" Child: *(thinks — excited, scared of missing out, like everyone has it)* You: "*What did it want you to do?*" Child: "*Buy it.*" You: "*What technique was it using? Scarcity? Social proof?*"

You don't need to know which technique. The child has been taught to name them. You just have to ask.

Prompt 2 — The grocery store endcap

You: "*Why is this product at the end of the aisle? Is it on sale, or is the price actually the same?*" Child: *(may not know — that's the point)* You: "*What would you check to find out?*"

Prompt 3 — The "limited time only" sign

You: "*This sign says 'today only.' Do you think it's actually only today?*" Child: *(answers)* You: "*What if it said 'today only' last week too? Is it scarcity or pressure?*"

Prompt 4 — The "doctors recommend" claim

You: "*Doctors recommend it? Which doctors? How would you find out?*"

You don't need to know the answer. The Cash to Company curriculum has taught your child what *authority* technique looks like. Your job is to ask the question.

One thing NOT to ask

Don't ask "*how much do we spend on this kind of stuff?*" The curriculum keeps family money private. Use these ad-spotting prompts at the level of "what is this ad doing" rather than "what is our family doing."

ROUND 2 PATCH — Three 30-Second Conversation Starters per Quarter (Grade 5)

Quarter 1 (Value Explanation) 1. *In a coffee shop:* "Why do people pay $5 for a coffee they could make at home?" — Follow-up: "Whats the *value* the shop adds?" 2. *Drive-time:* "Whats one thing thats expensive but worth it to you?" — Follow-up: "Why?" 3. *At dinner:* "Whats one business that creates value for kids?" — Follow-up: "How?"

Quarter 2 (Cost, Margin, Pricing) 1. *In the kitchen:* "If these cookies cost $2 to make and we sold them, what price would give us 40% margin?" — Follow-up: "What if margin was 50%?" 2. *Drive-time:* "Higher price always means more profit, right?" — Follow-up: "What if fewer people bought?" 3. *At a real lemonade stand:* "What does each cup cost them? What price? Whats their profit?" — Follow-up: "How many cups would they need to sell to make $20?"

Quarter 3 (30-Second Pitch + Inventory) 1. *At dinner:* "Pitch me your business idea in 30 seconds — customer, problem, price." — Follow-up: "Could a stranger understand it?" 2. *Drive-time:* "If you ran a stand for one day, what would you sell, and how would you know if you ran out?" — Follow-up: "How would you track inventory?" 3. *In a store:* "How does this store know they need more bread tomorrow?" — Follow-up: "What if they ran out?"

Quarter 4 (Spotting Persuasion + Market Day Debrief) 1. *Watching a commercial:* "What technique are they using — scarcity, bandwagon, or authority?" — Follow-up: "Whats missing? Is there evidence?" 2. *In a kid-aimed ad:* "Is this ad honest, or is it stretching the truth?" — Follow-up: "What would Cash ask?" 3. *After Market Day:* "What worked? What flopped? Whats one thing youd change next time?" — Follow-up: "Whats the evidence?"

Sensitivity: None of these prompts require the family to share home finances. They work for any family.

ROUND 2 PATCH — What Cash Never Says (Parent Reference)

Cash will never say: "Amazing!" / "Everyone can be rich" / "Easy money" / "Passive income" / "Just believe in yourself" (as substitute for evidence) / anything implying money problems are a personal failing.

Cash always asks: "Which people, and how do you know?" / "Whats the evidence?"

Why this matters at home. Your child will encounter financial-literacy content from many sources, some hustle-bro coded. The contrast is the point. Cash is on your familys side: clear-eyed, honest, never selling.

One question this year: "*Did Cash ask you a question this week? What was it?*"

FROM CASH

Money in, money out, money left

Revenue is loud. Cost is sneaky. Profit is what is actually yours. Track all three or you don't really know what's happening.

KEEP IT REAL

Real customers. Real money. Real lessons.

Every page in this book points back to one habit: ask a real person, listen to the real answer, count the real numbers. The rest is decoration.

STANDARDS ALIGNMENT

What Grade 5 hits

This curriculum book aligns to the following K-12 standards. See the *Master Standards Alignment Map* for the full grade-band crosswalk.

Jump$tart 5
Spending and saving - budgeting and cost-of-goods.

CEE NS8
Role of price in markets, supply and demand.

CCSS-MATH 5.NBT
Place value, decimals, multi-step money problems.

CCSS-ELA W.5.1
Write opinion pieces - pitch with evidence.

CASEL Self-Management
Goal-setting and planning.

C3 D2.Eco.7.3-5
Explain how profit motivates producers.

FROM CASH

One last thing

"*Revenue is loud. What's left is what you keep.*"

- CASH, GRADE 5

Revenue is loud. What's left is what you keep. — Cash

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